

can learn directly from industry leaders who drive market dynamics. “For students, it’s an amazing chance to hear real stories that connect what they learn in the class to how things work in the real world,” says Kulkarni. “They get to listen to firsthand experiences about leadership, strategy, and overcoming challenges from people across fields, which not only helps them understand better but also inspires them.”

These sessions are not simply inspirational, however. Often, they serve as the foundation for mentorship opportunities, internships, and job prospects for students. For CXOs, they provide an opportunity to reflect and distil lessons learnt over decades of experience and understand how the next generation views business, purpose, and leadership.

At T A Pai Management Institute (TAPMI), the shift is clear. Prof. Gururaj H Kidiyoor, Dean Academics, says students look forward to being taught by executives. “Corporate leaders bring real-world perspectives into the classroom, providing students insights into the strategic and tactical aspects of decision-making in business,” says Kidiyoor.

The benefits do not end there. The presence of industry executives helps students test the relevance of theoretical frameworks learnt in class. “Students also appreciate the fact that most of the theories in management come from the world of practice,” he says. At TAPMI, as much as 20-30% teaching is conducted by corporate leaders.

THE COMMUNICATION

IIM Bangalore has gone a step forward. Industry leaders who teach short modules or elective courses collaborate with the

school’s faculty members to design the course. In doing so, faculty members can ensure that each session maintains its academic rigour while remaining grounded in best practices.

“Teaching provides senior executives a glimpse of their future workforce and fresh ideas,” says Kulkarni. “It also gives them a moment to reflect on their own career journeys while connecting with bright, eager students about to enter their industries.”

Additionally, it connects them to new ideas and expectations. “The students also benefit from learning through live case materials, simulations, and crisis scenarios that reflect actual boardroom decision-making processes. Such interactions also lead to mentorships, projects, internships, and job opportunities in a wide range of industries.”

This is quickly becoming the new standard among management educational institutions throughout India. The Great Lakes Institute of Management (GLIM) has made industry collaboration a key component of its academic strategy. “Inviting corporate leaders into the classroom creates multidimensional value for students, industry partners, and the institution,” says Kiran Neti, Director & HoD-Corporate and Career Services, Great Lakes Institute of Management, Chennai. “For students, these interactions enhance academic learning with contemporary domain perspectives. Exposure to leaders who have navigated real business challenges enables students to contextualise theories, strengthen conceptual clarity, and understand business models in action. Such engagements sharpen critical thinking and provide the experiential mindset

EXECUTIVES JOIN IN

1 **B-schools are proactively inviting industry leaders to the classrooms to align education with real world practices**

2 **This creates a more engaging learning environment and a more direct connection between academia and the workplace**

3 **These sessions also serve as the foundation for mentorship opportunities, internships, and job prospects for students**

4 **For CXOs, they provide an opportunity to reflect and distil lessons learnt over decades of experience and understand how the next generation views business, purpose, and leadership**

5 **The presence of industry executives helps students test the relevance of theoretical frameworks learnt in class**

6 **Industry leaders who teach short modules or elective courses also collaborate with the school's faculty members to design the course**